had been members of the Ghadar Party were now in their eighties and known as '*Ghadari Baba* ' (revolutionary elders).

The knowledge and contact bank I built during this trip came in handy while discharging my consular duties in Ottawa and also during my three operational visits to Canada and the US, in 1981, 1982 and 1983, after I returned to Delhi. These details appear in this book at appropriate junctures.

Within a few months of my arrival in Ottawa I noticed that although some of the representational officers from the three Indian missions in Canada did interact at a personal level with prominent Sikh residents, there was hardly any interaction at the official level between them and the Sikh organizations or institutions whose activities revolved around the local gurudwaras.

In March 1977, the Congress had lost the general elections as a fallout of the Emergency and was replaced by the Morarji Desai-led Janata Party government. The Akali Dal was a member of the coalition government.

Though the Morarji Desai government was considered pro-US, in the Cold War environment India was still perceived to be closer to the Soviet Union because of the continued relevance of the Indo-Soviet Treaty of Friendship and Cooperation of 1971. Incidentally, it was signed at Moscow on 6 August 1971 between Sardar Swaran Singh as India's external affairs minister and A.A. Gromyko, his Soviet counterpart. As a result, bilateral relations between India and Canada lacked warmth and were at best correct, if not cold. Normally, such a relationship rubs off on persons of Indian origin settled in the host country, and Canada was no exception. In view of that, the local Sikhs were always conscious of the fact that any unwarranted institutional contact with the Indian missions in Canada may not be appreciated by Canadian authorities. As such, the change in government in India, despite having a pro-US prime minister, and the Akali Dal as a coalition partner, resulted in no perceptible change in the attitude of Sikhs in Canada towards the Indian missions.

While Vancouver and its suburbs had a number of gurudwaras, the main one was Khalsa Diwan Society Sikh Temple on 8000 Ross Street, Vancouver. In other cities both in central and eastern Canada,